

NASA INTERNATIONAL SPACE APPS CHALLENGE · 2026

BANGLADESH

Participants Guide — Local Events across Bangladesh

2026 THEME

The Next Frontier. From your own backyard to the edges of the universe, discovery awaits. Collaborate with a community of problem solvers to turn data into tools that benefit humanity and propel us to the Moon, Mars, and beyond.

Two days. Open data from NASA and its Space Agency Partners. No space background required.

01

What Space Apps is

Space Apps is the world's largest annual hackathon. Over one weekend, teams at hundreds of events around the world use open data from NASA and its Space Agency Partners to build solutions to real problems on Earth and in space. Challenges are written by NASA subject matter experts and span software, hardware, data science, design, and storytelling.

The 2025 edition, in numbers:

Registered participants	**114,094**	Challenges	**18**
Countries & territories	**167**	Space Agency Partners	**14 (17 in 2026)**
Teams	**18,860**	NASA subject matter experts	**124**
Projects submitted	**11,511**	Universal Event registrations	**8,025**
Local Events	**551**	Navigators	**78**
Social mentions reach	**617M**	Global Offers / collaborators	**11 / 19**

India, Egypt, Brazil, Türkiye, and the United States sent the most registrants in 2025. For 2026 the partner count rises to seventeen, with Angola, the Korea AeroSpace Administration, Nigeria's NASRDA, and Senegal's agency joining for the first time.

Bangladesh has competed since the inception of the NASA Space Apps Challenge in 2012 and has produced global winners four times. In 2026 the country returns with Local Events in cities nationwide, all feeding the same global judging pipeline.

02

Space Apps Challenge Brief

The NASA Space Apps Challenge 2026 comes to Bangladesh on Friday 13 and Saturday 14 November, across nine cities. Bangladesh runs a day ahead of the 14–15 November global window so the hackathon falls on the local weekend. Any Bangladeshi student can take part — from a city venue where one is confirmed, or virtually from anywhere in the country.

Continuing the legacy, with the Local Leads. Bangladesh has entered Space Apps since the challenge began in 2012, taking four global championships and putting teams into the finalist round again and again. The 2026 edition carries that record forward under the city Local Leads, who run the national edition together: nine cities, one shared calendar, one two-day format, one judging pipeline.

Bangladesh on the global podium

YEAR	TEAM	GLOBAL RESULT
2017	**Atto-Unmesh and Team Englitas**	Third and fifth place finishes
2018	**Team Olik**	Global champion — Best Use of Data
2019	**MidDayDreams**	Global Finalist
2020	**Team Mohakash** **Team BUET Zenith**	Global Finalist Honorable Mention
2021	**Team Mohakash**	Global champion — Best Mission Concept
2022	**Team Diamonds**	Global champion — Most Inspirational
2023	**Team Voyagers, Rajshahi**	Global champion — Best Use of Storytelling
2024	**103 Early Hints - Rajshahi** **405 Found - Universal**	Global Finalists
2025	**ExoVisionaries, Chattogram** **Team Nomad, Cumilla** **Vitruvian 6, Dhaka**	Global Finalists
2025	**Team Polaris - Barisal**	Honorable Mention

Four Bangladeshi teams have taken a global championship, and several more have reached the finalist round. In the most recent national cycle the nine cities produced over 500 projects; the fifty strongest teams were invited to the physical 48-hour hackathon and the rest competed virtually.

Run of show — Day 1, Friday 13 November

07:00	Team registration and breakfast
08:30	Mentor meet & greet — and register on the NASA website
10:30	Opening ceremony
11:15	Mentor meetup and Q&A
11:30	Mentor round — finalise team setup on the NASA site, member roles, presentation draft, judging criteria, 240 Seconds of Glory and the 30-second video; transcript and script help
12:30	Lunch and prayer break
15:00	Mentor round — judging criteria clarified, presentations heard, feedback given
16:30	Group and team photographs
18:00	Mentor round — finalise the 240-second presentation
18:30	Upload the 240-second video to the YouTube for your Local Lead provides
19:00	Live broadcast with NASA (to be confirmed)
21:00	Dinner break
22:00	Mentor round — feedback on NASA website content and the 30-second video

23:00	Hackathon continues — finalising the NASA page and the 30-second video

Run of show — Day 2, Saturday 14 November

07:30	Breakfast break
08:30	Mentor round — finalise the NASA website submission and the 30-second video
09:00	Final upload of the 30-second video to the NASA website
10:00	Judges and mentors round
11:00	Local judging starts — 240 Seconds of Glory
13:30	Lunch and prayer break
14:00	Award finalisation
16:30	Group and team photographs
18:00	Closing ceremony and award distribution
20:00	Thanks, and see you next year

All times Asia/Dhaka. Individual cities may shift a slot; your Local Lead confirms the final agenda.

Pre-event Data Bootcamp

- AI-native product engineering
- Using NASA data
- Building a winning Space Apps solution, plus an open Q&A

National mainstage

American International University-Bangladesh, 408/1 (Old KA 66/1), Kuratoli, Khilkhet, Dhaka 1229. Each city also runs its own Facebook page and WhatsApp group; event-wide questions go to the Bangladesh Space Apps Slack workspace.

Local logistics

Anowar Parvez Rabbi, Local Logistics Coordinator — design@basis.org.bd, +880 1886 886790. He also leads the pre-event Data Bootcamp.

City Local Leads

CITY	LEAD	CONTACT
Dhaka	Mohammad Mahdee-uz Zaman	mohammad.m.zaman@gmail.com
Chattogram	Abhijit Bhowmik — Chairman, Workspace Infotech Ltd	ovi775@gmail.com
Sylhet	Delwar Alam — Managing Director, Bugsbd Ltd	delwar@bugsbd.com
Rajshahi	Toufiq Elahi Plabon	event2@basis.org.bd

CITY	LEAD	CONTACT
Khulna	Sanzar Adnan Alam — CEO, Debug BD Ltd	ceo@debugbd.com
Barishal	Ariful Hasan Opu — CEO, e-soft	info@ahopu.com
Rangpur	Md Rifayet Islam Rifat — Founder & CEO, THESOFTKING Ltd	rifat@thesoftking.com
Mymensingh	Anisul Haq — Chairman, Tech Terrain IT Ltd	anisul@techterrain-it.com
Cumilla	Parves Kawser — MD & CEO, Piistech Ltd	rezakawser@gmail.com

03

The essentials

ITEM	DETAIL
Hackathon — Bangladesh	13–14 November 2026 (Friday and Saturday)
Global dates	14–15 November 2026 — Bangladesh runs one day ahead
Bangladesh pre-registration	Opens 25 August 2026 — required for local participation and local judging
NASA registration	Opens 26 August 2026 at spaceappschallenge.org — required for global judging
Videos you owe	Three: two 240-second videos (prescreening and local judging) and one 30-second final video for global judging
Cost	Free. No one may charge you to take part
Age	All ages. Participants under 18 must be registered by a parent or legal guardian and accompanied by them at all times during the event
Team size	1–6 people; solo entries are allowed
Where	A Local Event near you, in person or virtual — or the virtual Universal Event if there is no event near you
Time zone	BST (UTC+6); global deadlines are set in US Eastern Time

04

Two registrations, one project

Bangladesh runs a national pre-registration alongside the global NASA registration. They are separate systems and you need both. Teams lose their place every year by doing only one.

	BANGLADESH PRE-REGISTRATION	NASA SPACE APPS REGISTRATION
Opens	25 August 2026	26 August 2026
Where	The Bangladesh registration form, published by your Local Lead	spaceappschallenge.org
What it gets you	Your seat at a Bangladesh Local Event, and your place in local judging	Your team page, your challenge, and your entry into global judging
What you submit there	Your 240-second prescreening video by 1 October, then the local judging cut during the hackathon	Your final project — summary, demo, links, and data used
Skip it and…	You cannot take part locally or be judged locally	You have no project in the competition at all

READ THIS TWICE

Pre-registering in Bangladesh does not register you with NASA. Whatever happens at your local event, you must register your team and submit your final project on the NASA Space Apps website — that submission is the only thing global judges ever see. The closing date for Bangladesh pre-registration is set by the Local Leads and announced with the form; do not wait for it.

05

Mission timeline

DATE	MILESTONE	WHAT YOU DO
17 Aug 2026	Theme and Space Agency Partners announced	The Next Frontier is live. Seventeen Space Agency Partners join NASA this year, including four first-timers: Angola, the Korea AeroSpace Administration, Nigeria's NASRDA, and Senegal's space agency.
25 Aug 2026	Bangladesh pre-registration opens	Bangladesh only. Complete the Bangladesh registration form from your Local Lead and prepare your 240-second qualification video. This secures your seat at a Local Event and your place in local judging.
26 Aug 2026	NASA registration opens	Do this first. Create your account on spaceappschallenge.org and select a Bangladesh Local Event, or the Universal Event if none is near you. Seats at each Local Event are limited.
17 Sep 2026	Challenge summaries released; team formation opens	Build your team. Summaries show the shape of this year's challenges so you can recruit the right mix of skills. The Team Formation Participant Guide is published the same day.
1 Oct 2026	Prescreening video due, 11:59 PM	Bangladesh only. Your 240-second prescreening video must be on YouTube with the link in the Google Form. Miss it and you may not be at the local event.

DATE	MILESTONE	WHAT YOU DO
28 Oct 2026	Full challenge statements released	Choose and prepare. Shortlist two or three statements, then study the linked datasets before the weekend.
2 Nov 2026	Space Apps Connect opens	The global participant platform goes live for team coordination and project pages, alongside its Participant Guide. You submit from here.
13 Nov 2026	Global Offers available	Free tools, credits, and services go live, with the Project Submission and Judging & Awards Participant Guides — the same day Bangladesh begins.
13–14 Nov 2026	**THE BANGLADESH HACKATHON (Friday and Saturday)**	The global event is 14–15 November; Bangladesh runs a day ahead so teams work over the local weekend.
13 Nov 2026	Video 2 due, 6:30 PM — local judging cut	Bangladesh only. The 240-second local judging video, now with your demo and your NASA datasets named on camera. YouTube link in the form, file in the Google Drive folder.
14–15 Nov 2026	Global hackathon and submission deadline	Submission closes at the end of the global window on 15 November, published in US Eastern Time. Treat the close of your local event on Saturday 14 November as your real deadline.
14 Nov 2026	Video 3 due, 12:00 PM — the 30-second final video	Uploaded to YouTube or Vimeo, linked from the form and from your NASA project page. Your Local Lead needs it before nominations go to NASA.
16 Nov 2026	Local winners announced	Each city publishes its local winners, and the global nominations go forward to NASA.
December 2026	Global Nominees, Finalists, and Honorable Mentions announced	Judging happens first: experts from NASA, the Space Agency Partners, and industry evaluate the nominated projects.
January 2027	Global Winners announced	The final awards close out the 2026 cycle.

NO CHALLENGES YET

The 2026 challenges do not exist publicly yet. Summaries arrive on 17 September and full statements on 28 October, both written fresh for The Next Frontier. They appear at spaceappschallenge.org/2026/challenges — set “Show Challenges From” to “2026 NASA Space Apps Challenges” in the top-right corner, or you will be reading last year’s list. Nothing carries over, and a project built against a 2025 statement will not be judged.

06

Who should join

Students, technologists, and citizen scientists. No matter your age, skill level, or professional background, when you take part you join a global community that uses NASA open data to answer today’s most pressing science and space exploration challenges.

The strongest teams are the mixed ones — six developers usually lose to a team with a developer, a designer, a domain researcher, and someone who can tell the story in three minutes. Developers, designers and artists, data scientists, researchers, hardware and robotics engineers, storytellers and filmmakers, entrepreneurs, educators, students of any age, citizen scientists, and anyone curious enough to try.

Eligibility

- Open to all ages, all nationalities, all skill levels.
- Participants under 18 must be registered for the event by a parent or legal guardian, and must be accompanied by a parent or legal guardian at all times during the event.
- Full rules are in the Participant Terms & Conditions at spaceappschallenge.org/legal.

Team rules

- One to six members. Teams may be cross-city.
- One event per participant — your project competes there.
- You may finalise or change your team any time before you submit.

What counts as a project

- Software, hardware, a data product, a model, a game, a design, a film, or an article — all are valid.
- It must use open data from NASA or a Space Agency Partner.
- It must answer one published 2026 challenge.

NOBODY PAYS

Participation is free at every event, everywhere. If you are asked to pay money for any part of a NASA Space Apps event, do not pay anything — report it to info@spaceappschallenge.org.

07

Local Events in Bangladesh

Space Apps runs at hundreds of events around the world. Local Events are organised by Local Leads and may be in person or virtual; every Bangladesh event runs the same two-day format and feeds the same global judging pipeline. What differs is the venue, the mentors in the room, and the local prizes.

CITY	DIVISION	2026 STATUS
Dhaka	Dhaka	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/dhaka/
Chattogram	Chattogram	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/chattogram/
Sylhet	Sylhet	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/sylhet/
Rajshahi	Rajshahi	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/rajshahi/
Khulna	Khulna	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/khulna/
Barishal	Barishal	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/barisal/
Rangpur	Rangpur	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/rangpur/

CITY	DIVISION	2026 STATUS
Mymensingh	Mymensingh	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/mymensingh/
Cumilla	Chattogram	https://www.spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/cumilla/

Cities that have hosted Bangladesh Local Events in recent years. The confirmed 2026 list is published at spaceappschallenge.org; only a listed event can register participants and nominate projects. To bring Space Apps to a city that is not listed, see spaceappschallenge.org/host-an-event.

Your Local Events

Cities	Dhaka, Chattogram, Sylhet, Cumilla, Rangpur, Rajshahi, Khulna, Barisal, Mymensingh
Venue	TBD
Format	Virtual
Reporting time, day 1	7:00 AM

If a physical venue is confirmed

Physical venues are being planned alongside the virtual event. Where one is confirmed, it provides power, seating, and working internet; mentors on the floor across both days; and an opening briefing, checkpoints, and a closing pitch session.

If there is no event near you

- Register for the virtual Universal Event and take part from anywhere.
- Coordinate through Space Apps Connect and your team's own channel.
- Universal Event teams are judged on exactly the same criteria.

08

Your three videos

Bangladesh teams make three videos, not one video cut three ways. Two run to 240 seconds and gate your place locally; the third runs to 30 seconds and is all a NASA judge on the other side of the world will ever see. Budget real time for each — strong projects lose here every year.

VIDEO	MAXIMUM	MUST CONTAIN	WHERE IT GOES	DEADLINE
1 · Prescreening 240 Seconds of Glory Qualification and entry	**240 sec** 4 minutes	Team name Every team member, listed by name Problem and challenge statement Solution approach — concept only	Upload to YouTube, then paste the link into the Google Form	**1 October** 11:59 PM
2 · Local judging 240 Seconds of Glory	**240 sec** 4 minutes	Team name Every team member, listed by name Problem and challenge statement	Upload to YouTube and paste the link into the Google Form, and upload the file to the	**13 November** 6:30 PM

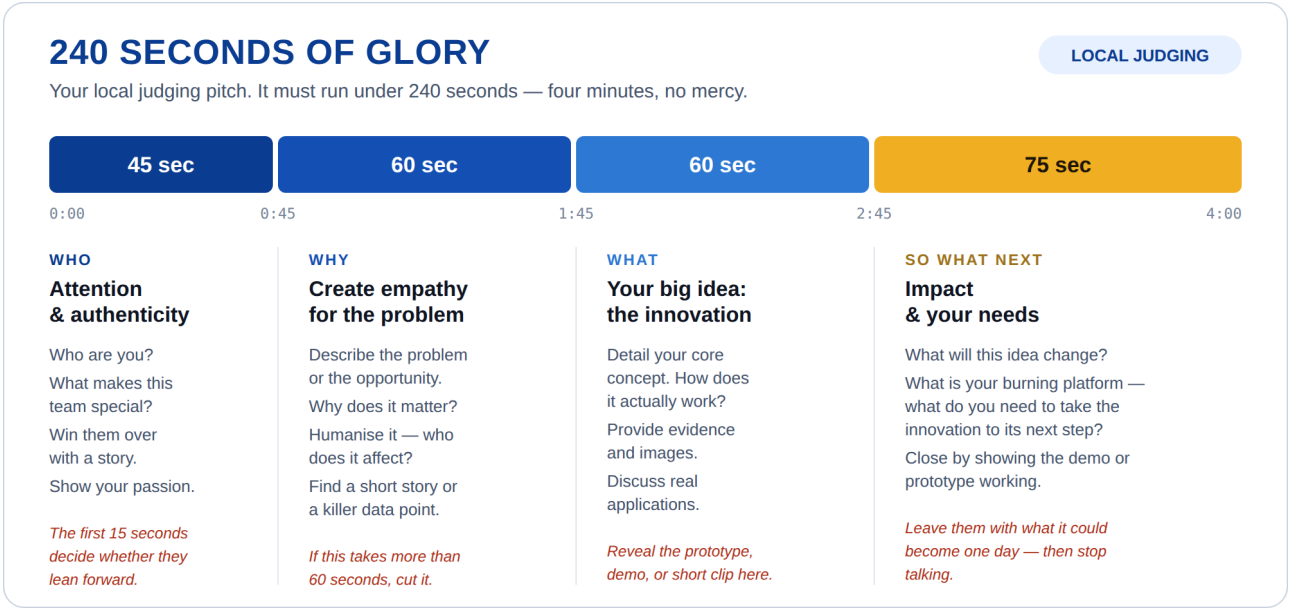
VIDEO	MAXIMUM	MUST CONTAIN	WHERE IT GOES	DEADLINE
Judged at your city event		Solution, plus a demo of it working State your NASA data usage out loud in the video	Google Drive folder provided	
3 · Global judging 30 Seconds of Glory The final video	**30 sec**	Team name Every team member, listed by name Problem and challenge statement Solution, plus a demo of it working State your NASA data usage All Space Apps documentation completed alongside it	Upload to YouTube or Vimeo, then paste the link into the Google Form and into your NASA project page	**14 November** 12:00 PM

CHECK WITH YOUR LEAD

Video 2's 1 November date sits oddly against the run of show in section 02, which puts the 240-second upload at 6:30 PM on Friday 13 November — day one of the hackathon. The time matches exactly, so 1 November may be a carry-over; treat the run of show as the working schedule and confirm with your Local Lead.

Video 3 is solid: the 12:00 PM cut-off on the final day is the long-standing rule for the global nomination video, and your Local Lead needs it before nominations go to NASA.

The prescreening video is due before challenge statements are published on 28 October, so build it from the challenge summaries released on 17 September. Concept only is fine at that stage — that is what the form asks for.



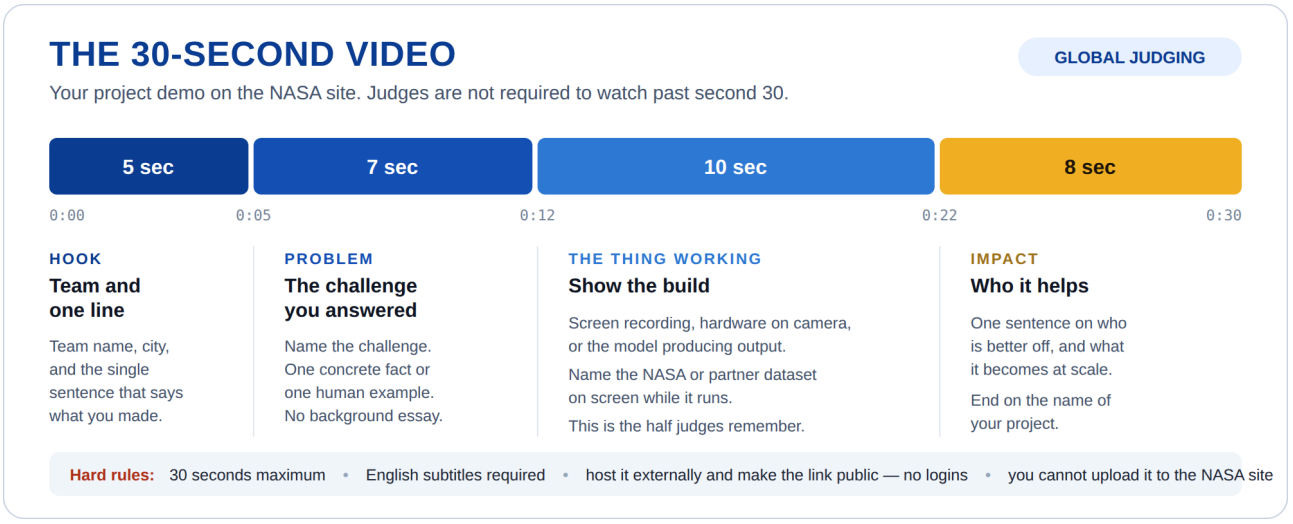
Adapted from the official NASA Space Apps 240 Seconds of Glory pitch model. Use it for both 240-second videos — video 1 stops at the concept, video 2 fills the third and fourth blocks with the working build.

Prescreening to local judging

- Video 1 secures your seat, and it can be re-cut right up to the hackathon.
- Video 2 is the same pitch with the demo dropped in and your NASA datasets named on camera.
- Video 2 goes to YouTube and to the Google Drive folder your Local Lead provides.

Hard limits on the 240s

- Under 240 seconds. Over-length videos get cut off, not excused.
- Name every team member — both videos, every time.
- Credit any third-party asset, template, or generated content you used.



A 30-second beat sheet. The hard rules are NASA's; the timings are a working suggestion, not a requirement.

Where video 3 goes

- YouTube or Vimeo, then the link goes into both the Google Form and your NASA project page.
- Test the link in a private window. If a judge cannot open it, your project cannot be judged.
- A seven-slide deck is an accepted NASA alternative to the video — but the video travels better.

Do not lose marks on this

- English subtitles are required on video demos; slide decks must be in English.
- No recognisable names, voices, or faces of anyone under 18.
- Show the thing working. A slideshow about a thing is not a demo of a thing.
- Finish your Space Apps documentation alongside video 3, not after it.

09

Be ready before day one

- **Registered and assigned to an event** — Do it the day registration opens.
- **Under 18? Guardian registered you and is coming** — They must be with you throughout the event.
- **240-second prescreening video uploaded** — YouTube link in the Google Form by 1 October, 11:59 PM.
- **Team confirmed, roles agreed** — Decide who builds, who researches, who presents.
- **NASA Earthdata account created** — Free, and the gateway to most Earth-observation datasets.
- **GitHub repository ready and public** — Judges look at what you actually built.
- **Environment set up and tested** — Install and test before you arrive, not at hour two.
- **Datasets downloaded offline** — Never rely on venue bandwidth for a large download.
- **Laptop, charger, extension cord, power bank** — Sockets run out fast.

- **Slide template and demo script started** — Two hours of prep saves you the last two hours.
- **Sleep, food, and water planned** — It is a two-day sprint, not an all-nighter contest.

10

Submitting on the NASA site

Everything global judges see lives on your NASA project page. Nothing else — not your local pitch, not the room you were in, not how hard the weekend was — reaches them. Fill it in properly during the hackathon, not in the last twenty minutes.

Step by step

1	Log in to spaceappschallenge.org.
2	Open the Members tab and make sure every team member is listed, with a photo and their role.
3	Add your team photo. This is the picture that runs beside your name if you win globally.
4	Go to your challenge category and topic.
5	Fill in every field below, with links and documentation.
6	Click Submit. An unsubmitted page is not judged.

What each field must contain

FIELD	WHAT GOES IN IT
High-Level Summary	Name your project, then summarise it: what you built, who it helps, how it works. Include the link to your 240-second video and your GitHub link here.
Project Demo	Your 30-second YouTube video, under 30 seconds, built to the beat sheet in section 08. A seven-slide deck is NASA's accepted alternative.
Final Project	The detail behind the build — Figma, GitHub, or other full documentation.
Project Details	Where you shine. Use pictures, detail, and links across the three blocks below.
GitHub or Drive access	Whatever you link must be open and public so any judge can evaluate it, with no login or permission request. Test it in a private window before you submit.
Use of AI	Every AI tool in your solution, named — with the prompts and reasoning behind them, and the data the AI worked on.
NASA data sources used	List every NASA and partner dataset, then say what you used it for and how. Judges check this against your claims.
References	Every source, paper, dataset, library, and asset you drew on.

The three Project Details blocks

- **The why, the what, the how** — How you addressed the challenge, and how you developed the project — listing every dataset you used, in detail.
- **Community involvement** — What you hope to achieve, anything important the reader must know, your highlighted features, and the benefits they bring.
- **Tools and technologies** — Tools, languages, and frameworks used, with credit given generously.

UNDER-18 RULE

Recognisable names, voices, and likenesses of people under the age of 18 must not appear in any video or project submission. Plan your demo around this from the start — reshooting on Saturday afternoon is a bad way to spend your last hours.

11

How you are judged

There are three passes, and one score sheet runs through all of them. Whether you sit at the mainstage in Dhaka or work from your bedroom in Cumilla, the same five judges score your city's projects against the same criteria.



To be eligible for any award, you must

- **Answer an official 2026 Space Apps challenge** — One published challenge, clearly named on your project page.
- **Link a public repository** — Code and documentation, openly accessible — test the link.
- **Use NASA open data** — Other data is welcome on top. NASA data is not optional.
- **Keep event code open source** — Anything you build during the weekend stays open.
- **Register and identify every team member** — On the team's NASA page, with roles.

The score sheet

#	CRITERION	POINTS	WHAT IT MEASURES
1	**Impact**	**1–20**	The scale and significance of the problem, and how far the solution reaches.
2	**Creativity**	**1–20**	Originality of the idea and of the execution.

#	CRITERION	POINTS	WHAT IT MEASURES
3	**Validity**	**1–20**	Scientific soundness, technical feasibility, usability.
4	**Relevance**	**1–20**	Alignment to the challenge, and how deeply NASA data sits at the core.
5	**Presentation**	**1–20**	Clarity, structure, storytelling, and reach to a broad audience.
6	Teamwork	1–5	Evidence of genuine collaboration across the team.
7	User experience	1–5	5 = anyone can use it. 1 = it needs significant training.
8	NASA data usage	1–5	5 = NASA open data plus other agency or third-party sources, clearly shown.
9	Challenge category identified	0 or 1	A 2026 challenge category is named.
10	Repository access	0 or 1	GitHub or Drive link works and is open to all.
11	Project page complete	0 or 1	The NASA project page is filled in and submitted.
—	**Women participation bonus**	**+5%**	Teams with one or more women members receive 5% on top of the aggregate.

Criteria 1–5 carry the headline 100 points. Criteria 6–8 add up to 15, and 9–11 add up to 3, for a maximum of 118 before the bonus. The 5% is applied to the aggregate at the end.

The anchor scale for criteria 1–5

SCORE	BAND	WHAT IT MEANS
20	**Absolutely wow**	The concept is unique. I could not have imagined it, and I don't think anyone else could either.
10	**Unique idea**	Idea and implementation are unique, but I have heard of a similar concept somewhere. I have not seen it built.
5	**Unique implementation**	The idea is already in the public domain, but this implementation is unique.
1	**Public domain**	Concept, idea, and implementation are all already available publicly.

1 · Impact

What is the project's potential for significant impact, in quality and quantity? Does it address a major problem or a minor one? How far does it inspire or help others?

20	Addresses a major global or local challenge with a transformative solution. Clear pathways to scale and sustain across regions or sectors. Inspires adoption by NGOs, policymakers, or startups. Measurable outcomes are plausible — emissions cut, lives saved, education reached.
10	A meaningful problem framed innovatively, but needing more work to scale globally. Impact is real but limited to a smaller audience or proof-of-concept.
5	A moderate or local issue. Useful to a niche audience, harder to scale beyond the team's own community.

1	Minimal impact. A minor issue, or little added value beyond what already exists publicly.

Judges ask: Who benefits? How many? How measurable is the positive effect?

2 · Creativity

How original is the approach? Is this a novel concept, or a meaningful improvement on an existing one? Does the creativity distinguish it from conventional methods?

20	A bold, original idea, or a radical new spin on existing work. Makes unexpected connections — cross-disciplinary, cultural, artistic, gamified. Sets a new benchmark.
10	Genuine originality and a new perspective, though similar approaches exist. A clear improvement or remix that adds real value.
5	A widely known concept, but the team shows creativity in execution — design, storytelling, or application.
1	Conventional, predictable, undistinguished.

Judges ask: Does this feel fresh and surprising, or predictable and routine?

3 · Validity

Is the method grounded in scientific principles? Is it technically feasible? Would it work in the real world, and can an ordinary person use it?

20	Scientifically robust, using validated data and methods. Technically feasible with a working prototype or demo. Usability tested, accessible beyond experts, with clear performance metrics.
10	Largely valid but needing more testing. The prototype shows feasibility without stress-testing or broader validation. Some usability work in place.
5	Partially valid. Methods align with science but are oversimplified. The prototype works under limited conditions; usability is minimal or inconsistent.
1	Not scientifically credible, technically impractical, or unable to show basic feasibility.

Judges ask: Would this work if deployed tomorrow? Is it rigorous and trustworthy?

4 · Relevance

Does the project fully and directly answer the challenge it was submitted against? Is NASA data a core component of the method, or a superficial addition?

20	Fully aligned with the selected challenge and beyond expectations. NASA data is central and used creatively, not merely cited. Deep understanding of both challenge and dataset, with reproducible, transparent data usage.
10	Strong alignment, but NASA data integration is moderate — helpful rather than essential. The challenge is addressed meaningfully, with some aspects underexplored.
5	Partial relevance. Responds to the challenge loosely. NASA data is referenced but not integral to the solution.
1	Weak alignment. NASA data is barely used, or irrelevant to the main idea.

Judges ask: Is this NASA-data-first, or just NASA-data-added?

5 · Presentation

How clearly did the team convey the challenge, the method, and why it matters? How well-structured and engaging was the storytelling?

20	Flawless: a clear, structured, compelling narrative with a beginning, middle, and end. Polished visuals and audio, in clear English. Connects emotionally and intellectually. Leaves judges saying, “I get it, and it matters.”
10	Very good, with gaps in clarity, pacing, or flow. Visuals engaging but uneven in polish. English is clear and understood.
5	Adequate but rushed, unclear, or missing key elements. Visuals are good but need polishing; the language repeats itself and could be tightened.
1	Confusing, incomplete, or poorly executed. Graphics, audio, and video need work, and judges struggle to follow the purpose.

Judges ask: Could a global audience understand and remember this in 240 seconds?

JUDGING FAIRLY

Judges are briefed to check themselves for affinity bias — favouring people with similar backgrounds and interests; confirmation bias — favouring what supports their existing beliefs; and the halo effect — letting one positive impression colour everything else. Every team in a region is scored by the same panel of five judges. That is the structural guarantee behind the promise that where you sat does not matter.

NOTE FOR JUDGES

At the prescreening pass, projects arrive incomplete — NASA has not published the full challenge statements yet. Score them from that perspective. The one non-negotiable: read the challenge, and check that the presentation actually answers it. That is what relevance is measuring.

Awards and nominations

At your city

AWARD	HOW MANY	WHO GETS IT
Local winners	Up to 2	The top-scoring projects at your location, by the score sheet in section 11. The exact number depends on how many teams finally submitted.
Innovation Space / People’s Choice	0 or 1 (optional)	A project that won nothing else but made strikingly creative use of NASA open data, or was simply inspirational. Judges may decline to give it.
Global nomination	1 per 10 projects submitted	Counted against the projects on the submission page at the final submission time. Twenty submissions means two nominations; every further ten adds one.

FINAL MEANS FINAL

Local judging is at the discretion of the panel appointed for each location, and the decision is final. Nominations are decided behind closed doors and cannot be appealed — a team that challenges the decision is automatically removed from global nomination.

Globally

NASA experts review nominations from Local Leads worldwide, shortlist roughly thirty Global Finalists, and pick one winner in each category below. They judge from your project page — so keep the description, the video, and the open-source links current right through the judging window. Global winners are featured on the Space Apps website and invited to visit a NASA centre with the Global Organizing Team; travel, meals, and accommodation are the winners' own responsibility.

CATEGORY	AWARDED TO
Best Use of Science	The solution making the best and most valid use of science or the scientific method.
Best Use of Data	The solution that best makes space data accessible, or applies it uniquely.
Best Use of Technology	The solution exemplifying the most innovative use of technology.
Galactic Impact	The solution with the most potential to improve life on Earth or in the universe.
Best Mission Concept	The solution with the most plausible concept and design.
Most Inspirational	The solution that captures our hearts.
Best Storytelling	The solution that most creatively communicates the potential of open data through storytelling.
Global Connection	The solution that best connects people around the world through technology.
Art & Technology	The solution that most effectively combines technical and creative skills.
Local Impact	The solution demonstrating the greatest potential for local impact.

Local judges also tick which of these categories they are nominating a project for. That is a yes/no mark, not a score — it does not affect your points.

Why it is worth your weekend

- **Real data, real stakes** — You work with the same open datasets used by scientists and mission teams, on problems written by the people who study them.
- **A portfolio piece** — A finished, documented, publicly judged project is worth more in an application than any certificate.
- **A global stage** — Bangladeshi teams have won global categories before. The nomination path from your city to NASA judging is short and real.
- **The network** — Mentors, judges, and the people you build with over two days tend to stay in your life far longer than the weekend.

Conduct and support

- **The standard** — Space Apps aims to be a place where everyone feels they belong, is comfortable being authentic, and is empowered to contribute fully. Discrimination, harassment, and bullying in any form are not tolerated.
- **If you experience or witness it** — Contact your Local Lead, the NASA Space Apps Global Organizing (GO) Team at conduct@spaceappschallenge.org, or both. The GO Team will take appropriate action, which may include warning or expelling offending participants from the event.
- **Accessibility** — If you need step-free access, an interpreter, a quiet space, or anything else to participate fully, contact your Local Lead before the event so it can be arranged.

Questions we get every year

Where do my code and documentation go?

Push everything to GitHub and give the link: your code, your full documentation, your journey, your project description, your video, your poster, and any other links. Google Drive or OneDrive is accepted instead — but the folder must be set to full public access, and you should test it in a private window before you submit.

Can I use someone else's content?

No. You may not use copyrighted material, or anything owned by someone else, without their explicit consent. This applies to code, images, audio, footage, and datasets alike.

Can I use AI-generated content?

Yes, with conditions: you need a valid reason for using it, you must explain your prompts, and you must show where your own creative work went. Unexplained generated content is not acceptable, and any tool used to generate content must be named in your description.

What about stock content?

If you intend to win, do everything yourself. Where you genuinely must use royalty-free material, add a disclaimer, credit the source, and give a valid reason for using it.

And premium or paid content?

Allowed, with proper credits, disclaimers, and reasons — provided it supports your solution rather than being it. A purchased website theme is fine when the content on the site is yours; a Figma template is fine when you have customised it. The core must be your own work.

Where do I find this year's challenges?

At spaceappschallenge.org/2026/challenges. Set "Show Challenges From" in the top-right corner to "2026 NASA Space Apps Challenges" — the page can default to a previous year, and every year teams build against the wrong list. Summaries land 17 September, full statements 28 October.

Bookmarks and contacts

Bookmark these

2026 challenges	https://spaceappschallenge.org/2026/challenges
Your city's event page	https://spaceappschallenge.org/2026/locations/<city>/ — your Local Lead gives you the exact link
NASA Earthdata sensors	https://earthdata.nasa.gov/user-resources/remote-sensors
NASA open data	https://data.nasa.gov
NASA APIs	https://api.nasa.gov
Learn the NASA API	https://youtube.com/watch?v=WXsD0ZgxjRw · youtube.com/watch?v=JfXp_YEQRRI
Your repository	https://github.com — public, and tested in a private window
Participant FAQs	https://spaceappschallenge.org/resources/participant-faqs
Terms & conditions	https://spaceappschallenge.org/legal

Talk to someone

Register — Bangladesh	Ask your Local Lead; pre-registration and video submission run through the Bangladesh form: https://www.nasaspaceappsbd.com/
Register — NASA	https://spaceappschallenge.org
Bangladesh community	spaceappsbd.slack.com · @spaceappsbd · city Facebook pages and WhatsApp groups from your Local Lead
General enquiries	Start with your local lead first and then info@spaceappschallenge.org
Conduct concerns	conduct@spaceappschallenge.org — the Global Organizing (GO) Team
Local logistics	Anowar Parvez Rabbi, Local Logistics Coordinator — design@basis.org.bd, +880 1886 886790 And your designated local lead

Contacts for Local Events in Bangladesh

Space Apps runs at hundreds of events around the world. Local Events are organised by Local Leads and may be in person or virtual; every Bangladesh event runs the same two-day format and feeds the same global judging pipeline. What differs is the venue, the mentors in the room, and the local prizes.

City	Division	2026 event page	Local Lead
Dhaka	Dhaka	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/dhaka/	**Mohammad Mahdee-uz Zaman** mohammad.m.zaman@gmail.com

Chattogram	Chattogram	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/chattogram/	**Abhijit Bhowmik** ovi775@gmail.com
Sylhet	Sylhet	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/sylhet/	**Delwar Alam** delwar@bugsbd.com
Rajshahi	Rajshahi	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/rajshahi/	**Toufiq Elahi Plabon** event2@basis.org.bd
Khulna	Khulna	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/khulna/	**Sanzar Adnan Alam** ceo@debugbd.com
Barishal	Barishal	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/barisal/	**Ariful Hasan Opu** info@ahopu.com
Rangpur	Rangpur	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/rangpur/	**Md Rifayet Islam Rifat** rifat@thesoftking.com
Mymensingh	Mymensingh	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/mymensingh/	**Anisul Haq** anisul@techterrain-it.com
Cumilla	Chattogram	spaceappschallenge.org/2026/local-events/cumilla/	**Parves Kawser** rezakawser@gmail.com

All nine Bangladesh Local Events are live on the Space Apps site. Register for the city you will compete from — that is where your project is judged and nominated. Your Local Lead also runs the Bangladesh pre-registration form, the mentor roster, and the Google Drive folder for the local judging video.

#NASASpaceApps #SpaceApps2026 #TheNextFrontier #SpaceAppsBangladesh #Bangladesh #Hackathon #NASAOpenData #STEM #Innovation

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Dates follow the official NASA Space Apps Challenge 2026 timeline. Verify at spaceappschallenge.org before you rely on them. Theme artwork © NASA Space Apps Challenge.